

COWORK STARTER KIT

Five minutes from download to a working setup.

You downloaded the kit. Now you need three things: open it in Cowork, paste one prompt, answer one question. By the end of this PDF you will have a working AI setup tuned to your practice. No terminal, no command line, no git.

THREE STEPS

Open the folder, paste the prompt, answer one question.

01 Open the folder in Cowork.

Open the Claude desktop app. Switch to Cowork mode. Select the folder you just unzipped (it is called something like cowork-starter-kit-v0.1.0; you can rename it to anything). Cowork now has read and write access to the kit, your CLAUDE.md, and your skills. If Cowork is new to you, the Claude app walks you through enabling it the first time you click into the mode; follow its prompts.

02 Copy the prompt below. Paste it into Cowork as your first message.

Select all the text in the dark block on the next page. Copy it. Paste into Cowork. Hit send. Claude reads the kit, lists what it found, then asks you one question.

03 Answer the question Claude asks.

Claude will ask: "What is the single most annoying, recurring thing you do every week that you wish a system handled?" Answer with a real friction. Claude turns it into a custom skill in the same session.

WHERE DOES MY DATA LIVE?

Everything stays on your Mac, in the folder you picked. The kit does not transmit data anywhere. Cowork itself sends your messages and the file contents Claude needs to Anthropic; that is true of any Claude usage. No data goes to GitHub, no data goes to Sidekick.

THE BOOTSTRAP PROMPT

Copy everything in the dark block. Paste into Cowork.

This is the only prompt you ever need to memorize, and you do not need to memorize it. You paste it once, on day one. From session two onward, you just talk to Claude in plain English.

COPY FROM HERE

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I just set up the Cowork Starter Kit in this folder and opened it in Cowork. This is my first session. Walk me through the setup.

Step 1. Read these files in this order:
1. README.md (top of repo)
2. CLAUDE.md (top of repo)
3. .claude/skills/README.md
4. The five SKILL.md files under .claude/skills/

Step 2. Confirm you read them by listing the five skill names and the four core folders. One sentence per item.

Step 3. Then ask me this question, only this question:

"What is the single most annoying, recurring thing you do every week that you wish a system handled? Be specific. Tell me the actual thing, not the category."

Wait for my answer. Do not suggest examples until I have answered.

Step 4. Once I answer, do these four things in order:

a. Restate the friction in one sentence so I know you understood it.
b. Ask me three to five questions to scope the skill (input shape, output shape, where to save, how often, words to avoid).
c. Draft the new SKILL.md using the same frontmatter format as the existing skills. Show me the draft before saving.
d. Once I approve, save it. Then run the skill once on a real example I provide.

Step 5. After the skill runs, give me three things in one short message:
- Whether the output is what I expected
- Where I can edit the skill if I want to change it
- One next thing I might want to do

Then stop. The first session is one skill plus orientation.

Rules for this session: No em dashes. No double dashes. Direct answers. Confirm before writing files. If I am unclear, ask one question.

When you are ready, start with Step 1.
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WHAT YOU WILL SEE IN THE NEXT 15 MINUTES

Claude reads the kit (about 30 seconds). Lists the five skills loaded. Asks the question above. You answer. Claude scopes the skill (3 to 5 quick questions). Drafts the SKILL.md. You approve. Claude saves it and runs it on a real input you paste. Total time: 15 to 20 minutes from this paste to first useful output.

COMMON THINGS TO SAY

Twelve sentences that turn the kit into an operating environment.

You do not invoke skills by name. You describe what you want in plain English. These are the patterns that work.

"Here are my notes from the call with Marcy. Run an after-meeting brief."

Triggers the after-meeting-brief skill. Paste your voice memo or scratch notes; Claude returns a structured follow-up plus a draft email.

"Pull up Marcy's file."

Reads People/Marcy_Tran.md and surfaces what you have on her. If the file does not exist, Claude offers to create one.

"Update Marcy's file with what we just discussed."

Appends new context to her People file. The kit compounds when you do this after every meaningful conversation.

"Compare these three carriers."

Triggers the product-comparison skill. Paste the brochures or rate sheets; Claude returns a side-by-side table plus a recommendation.

"Pipeline pulse on this client list."

Triggers the pipeline-pulse skill. Paste your active pipeline; Claude returns who is going cold, who is at decision, what to do about each.

"Draft a renewal letter from these notes."

Triggers the document-generator skill. Paste meeting notes plus the document type; Claude returns a first draft with blanks listed.

"Run the weekly capture on this week's notes."

Triggers the weekly-capture skill. Friday afternoon discipline: paste the week, get the Monday-ready distill back. Compounds across weeks.

"Help me draft a follow-up email to Marcy."

No skill needed. Just ask. Claude does ad-hoc work without a skill structure when you do not need a recurring pattern.

"Save this to Reference as Carrier_Cheat_Sheet.md."

Files what is in your chat into the Reference folder so Claude can find it next session. Use this for product info, pricing, ICP definitions, anything you will refer to often.

"Move this to TO DELETE."

Removes a file safely. Nothing is gone until you empty TO DELETE on your own time. Use instead of asking Claude to delete; the kit is built to never delete files outright.

"Edit the after-meeting-brief skill. Add [thing] to the output."

Opens the SKILL.md for that skill so you can change the output format, the trigger phrases, anything. Skills are yours to modify.

"Wrap up." or "Update the docs."

Triggers the session-close protocol. Claude saves any People file updates, graduates Active items if they are done, and closes cleanly. Say this before you close the chat.

THE MOST IMPORTANT PHRASE

"Wrap up" or "Update the docs" before you close the chat. Without this, the conversation context evaporates and your People files do not get the updates they need. The kit compounds when you close out cleanly. Five seconds of habit, weeks of compounding value.

OPERATING THE KIT

Four things to know that turn the kit into a system.

WHAT GOES WHERE

If it is about **a person**, it goes in **People/**. If it is a **recurring fact about your practice** (your ICP, product cheat sheets, standard templates), it goes in **Reference/**. If it is something you are **still working on**, it goes in **Active/**. If it is **finished or stale**, it goes in **TO DELETE/**. Tell Claude where to put things; Claude does the filing.

TROUBLESHOOTING

If a skill does not fire

You describe what you want, Claude responds conversationally instead of producing the structured output. Almost always the trigger phrase did not match closely enough. Two fixes: rephrase using words from the SKILL.md description, or open the SKILL.md and add your phrasing to the description's trigger list. The skill is yours to tune.

If your Mac asks how to open a .md file

Choose TextEdit. The format warning that appears is harmless; .md files are plain text underneath. You can also right-click the file, choose "Get Info," and set TextEdit as the default for all .md files so the prompt does not appear again.

PERMISSION TO EDIT

Nothing is locked.

Every file in the kit is yours to edit. CLAUDE.md, the skills, the example files, the README. The worst case if you break something is that you delete the file and re-download the kit. There is no upstream you are deviating from; this is your copy.

THE CADENCE THAT COMPOUNDS

If you remember nothing else from this PDF.

- Run weekly-capture every Friday afternoon. By week four you see patterns across your practice that no CRM surfaces.
- Run pipeline-pulse every Monday morning. The going-cold list alone pays for the time.
- Update People files at the end of any meaningful call. The kit compounds the most here.
- Build a new custom skill when you notice yourself doing the same manual thing for the third time.
- Wrap up before you close every session. "Update the docs" is five seconds and saves a week of context.

YOUR FIRST MONTH

Four weeks. One focus per week. By week four you know.

The kit gives you a working setup on day one. The compounding shows up in week three or four, when Claude starts referencing context you fed it weeks earlier without you having to re-explain. This is the runway that gets you there.

W1 Run the bootstrap. Build your first custom skill.

Today's session. Paste the prompt, answer the question, build a skill on a real friction. Run it once on real input. Confirm it produces what you wanted. Total time: 15 to 20 minutes.

W2 Populate three to five People files with your active clients.

Pick the clients you have ongoing work with. For each, paste what you know into the chat and ask Claude to file it as `People/[Name].md`. Use the Example_Client.md.example as the format. Update each file at the end of any call this week.

W3 Build one Reference doc. Run weekly-capture for the first time.

Pick the most recurring fact about your practice (your ICP, your carrier panel, your standard email patterns). Tell Claude to save it to Reference/. Friday afternoon, run weekly-capture on your week's notes; save the output to Active/Weekly_Distill_[date].md. This is the start of the compounding loop.

W4 Build your second custom skill. Review what is working.

By now you have noticed another recurring task that is costing you time. Build the second skill the same way you built the first. Then look back: which People files are growing, which skills you actually use, what you would change. The kit is yours to tune.

BY WEEK FOUR, YOU KNOW

Whether the kit fits your practice or does not. If it does, you keep going; the compounding is just starting. If it does not, you have spent under three hours total and you have lost nothing. Either outcome is honest.

WHEN DIY RUNS OUT OF ROAD

If by week four the kit fits but you want it tuned exactly to your practice, with skills built around your specific clients and products, that is what Sidekick Solo is. We do the build, you keep the implementation. One engagement, one fixed price, no monthly tax. sidekickorchestration.ai